

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 8: ASHES

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - CHIEF'S STUDY - NIGHT

Tobi enters to find Mrs. Adeyemi beside the locked wooden box. Kunle and Yewande stand opposite her.

TOBI

What is in the box?

MRS. ADEYEMI

Your father's last attempt to tell the truth.

She gives the key to Kunle. Tobi steps forward.

TOBI

Let Mr. Obi see it.

KUNLE

You heard what happened at the memorial.

TOBI

I heard Yewande turn a man into a public accusation.

YEWANDE

He arrived with a claim.

TOBI

Father arrived with a debt.

Kunle opens the box. Inside: an unsent letter and a replacement deed.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Do not destroy them.

KUNLE

If this leaves the room, the company becomes a public confession.

YEWANDE

The deed is what matters.

TOBI

The letter names the deed.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - CHIEF'S STUDY - CONTINUOUS

Kunle reads the first lines. His hands begin to shake.

KUNLE

He admitted it.

MRS. ADEYEMI

He wanted the truth in the house.

YEWANDE

He wanted to die clean.

TOBI

That is not the same thing.

KUNLE

You do not know what this does to the people still alive.

TOBI

I know what it does to the man you tried to buy.

Kunle moves toward the fireplace.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Kunle.

KUNLE

I am protecting the company.

He feeds the letter to the flame. Yewande tears the deed into strips and drops them after it.

TOBI

You are destroying proof.

YEWANDE

We are destroying a family problem.

Mrs. Adeyemi watches the handwriting disappear.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - GARAGE - NIGHT

Smoke follows them into the garage. Tobi blocks Kunle's car.

TOBI

You burned Father's last word.

KUNLE

I protected his company.

TOBI

You protected a lie.

YEWANDE

Your father built a fortune and you want to turn it into a moral exercise.

TOBI

He wrote the codicil because he knew what the fortune cost.

YEWANDE

He wrote it because he was weak.

TOBI

And you are strong enough to burn his last word.

YEWANDE

You are a spoiled brat and a coward.

TOBI

Do not call me that.

YEWANDE

All conscience and no spine. You like feeling bad about the family's money while keeping it.

The garage door begins to close, dividing them into separate rectangles of light.

CUT TO:

INT. OBI FAMILY HOME - FRONT ROOM - LATER

Ify sits with the original agreement. Mr. Obi tells her what he never did.

MR. OBI

Your grandfather and Chief's father were equal partners.

IFY

The deed changed that.

MR. OBI

A copied signature made the Adeyemi side sole owner.

IFY

And Chief knew.

MR. OBI

He learned when he was already a man. He was ashamed. He was also afraid.

IFY

You stayed for his shame.

MR. OBI

I stayed for your safety. The shame came with the job.

IFY

You let me believe you were only their driver.

MR. OBI

That was the work I could keep.

A message appears on Ify's phone from Tobi: I AM GOING TO REPORT THEM.

IFY

He wants me to stand behind him now.

MR. OBI

You do not have to stand behind anyone.

CUT TO:

EXT. OBI FAMILY HOME - SIDE GATE - NIGHT

Tobi stands outside the closed gate, phone in hand. Ify opens the pedestrian latch but does not invite him through.

TOBI

I am reporting the waiver and the destruction of the evidence.

IFY

Because you finally chose the right side?

TOBI

Because they did something current. The history belongs in a civil record.

IFY

And what do you want from me?

TOBI

Nothing.

IFY

Good. Start there.

She closes the latch. Tobi looks at the dark house and begins walking toward the road.

FADE OUT.